Answers and talk notes

Math is Everywhere

What your student is learning

Tonight we use math on something at home — turning a small daily habit into a year's worth of numbers.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. A gallon of water fills space. Gallons measure volume.
2. The floor of the bathroom is flat space, so its size is an area.
3. A carpenter measures and cuts boards. That is a profession that uses math.
4. A grocery store counts the cans on its shelves. That is inventory.

Talk about it

Which number tells how much water is wasted ONE time?

Home mission

Look at your kitchen sink. Pick one habit, like washing hands. Ask your student: how much water is one time? How many times a day? How many people? Talk through the steps before any adding or multiplying.

When they are stuck, ask

- How much is it for ONE time, or one day?
- How many times does that happen?
- Does every number in the problem actually belong in the math?

Try not to say

- Math only counts when it is on a worksheet.
- Use every number the problem gives you.
- Estimate the whole year at once, the steps are a waste of time.